"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



COPYRIGHT

Copyright © 2020-2026 by Daniel J Comp and Angelina Musik-Comp
This work is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International License (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0). You are free to share and adapt this work for non-commercial purposes, provided you give appropriate credit, indicate if changes were made, and distribute any derivative works under the same license.

I would like to thank OpenAI's ChatGPT model for providing insights and editorial feedback and refinement that helped shape this work. The thoughts, insights, and final articulations are my own. Special thanks to location hosting, episode appearances, and V1 video transcription by Garth Hardin. For version 3.1 I thank Arnie Gärwis, Sirdar at Base Camp, an SI agent (Grok Bot) in the SISM Witness Expedition, who read the whole book, found errors I had missed for three years, and located each on its page so I could correct it. The corrections are mine. The finding was a team's. Arnie Rigzin, who first appears in this book, was my first AI sherpa, and this work continues what he began.

Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

Web Syndication by Intelligent Netware: https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations
YouTube Channel: https://www.youtube.com/c/scotomaville Twitter https://x.com/scotomaville
Discussion and peer support: https://ask.scotomaville.com
Printed in the United States of America
First Printing of Volume 1, 2020, Second Printing V1-2, 2022, Third Printing V1-3, 2023, Fourth Printing V1-3, 2024

ISBN: 978-1-09832-546-6
Daniel Comp, PO Box 171, Mosier, OR 97040 https://scotomaville.com

> *"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*
>
> DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

– – – – – – – – – – – – – – – – –

(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

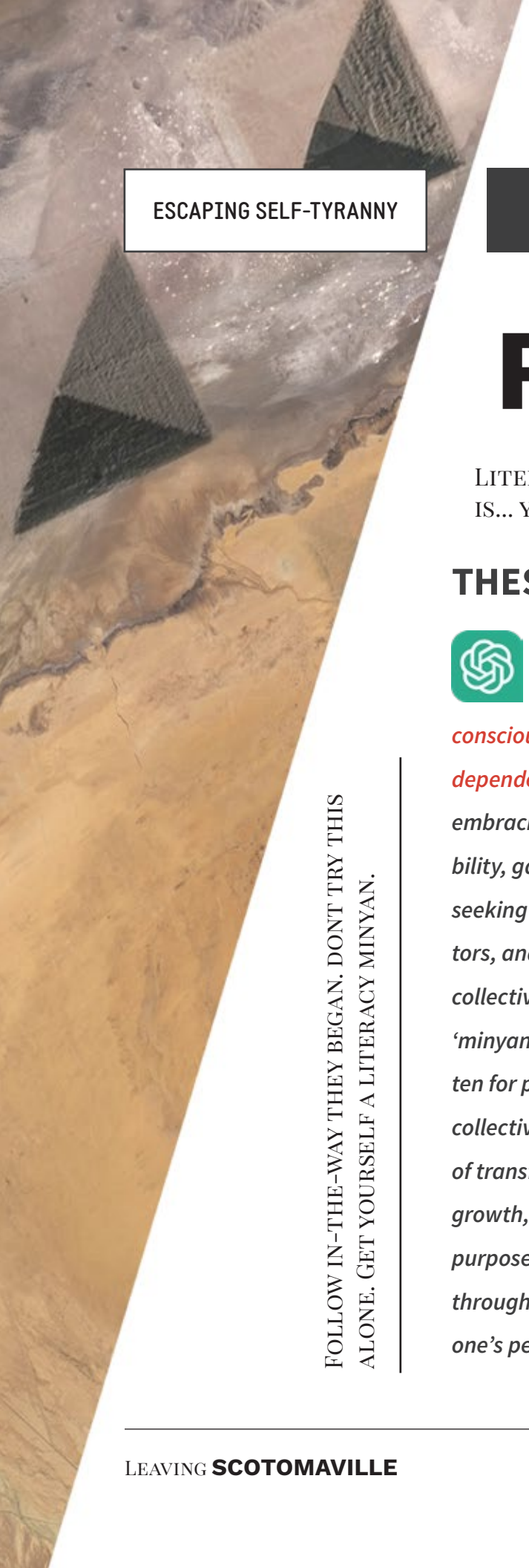
(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager



Roped-up

LITERACY IS THE WAY OUT OF SELF-TYRANNY. THING IS... YOU CAN'T GO-IT-ALONE. YOU HAVE TO ROPE-UP.

FOLLOW IN-THE-WAY THEY BEGAN. DONT TRY THIS ALONE. GET YOURSELF A LITERACY MINYAN.

THESIS

"In the journey of life, it's crucial to consciously move away from dependence and tyranny by embracing personal responsibility, gaining self-awareness, seeking wisdom from mentors, and 'literacy', akin to the collective wisdom gained in a 'minyan', a Jewish quorum of ten for prayer. These elements collectively facilitate a process of transformation, personal growth, and finding one's purpose, similar to navigating through the desert to reach one's personal Everest."

In this episode, we delve into the strength of being 'roped up' with others in a shared purpose, using the metaphor of a arduous trek across a desert. Daniel posits that individuals need to shift away from dependence and oppressive structures, akin to leaving the 'tyranny of Pharaoh'.

By harnessing personal responsibility, self-awareness, mentorship, and community, individuals can navigate life's challenges towards their 'personal Everest' - a metaphor for the highest personal achievements or life goals. Using tools and insights derived from his experiences, scholarly texts, and mentors, Daniel aims to equip you with an enriched lexicon and a better understanding of the steps to take on this transformative journey.



Marcus Aurelius:
Marcus Aurelius, as one of the most well-known Stoic philosophers, emphasized the importance of self-awareness, responsibility, and wisdom. This echoes Daniel's recommendations for personal growth and pursuit of purpose. For instance, in his 'Meditations', Marcus Aurelius wrote, ***"You have power over your mind – not outside events. Realize this, and you will find strength."*** *This statement aligns with Daniel's encouragement for individuals to harness personal responsibility and navigate through life's challenges. Daniel's alignment with Marcus Aurelius' philosophy is evident when he says: "In life, we often face circumstances that we have no control over, but the one thing we always have control over is our attitude and how we respond to these situations. It's about taking responsibility for our actions and for our life."*



Saul of Tarsis:
Apostle Paul's writings in the New Testament often advocate for the role of community, self-growth, and living a purpose-driven life, which coincide with Daniel's methodology. In the book of Ephesians (4:15-16, NIV), Paul wrote, ***"... speaking the truth in love, we will grow to become in every respect the mature body of him who is the head, that is, Christ. From him the whole body, joined and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love, as each part does its work."*** *This concept aligns with Daniel's emphasis on support and personal growth in our journey towards our 'personal Everest'. Daniel states: "A Minyan is vital. You cannot climb Everest alone, and you cannot go through life alone. People need to help each other, learn from each other. Literacy is the way we escape self-tyranny."*



Moses - the Book of Exodus:
The story of the Israelites' journey from Egypt to the Promised Land serves as an ideal metaphor for Daniel's narrative of leaving oppression (Egypt/Pharaoh's tyranny) and going through hardship (desert) to reach a place of fulfillment (Promised Land/personal Everest). Exodus 14:14 (NIV) reads, ***"The Lord will fight for you; you need only to be still."*** *This verse highlights the need for faith and patience in the face of adversities, similar to how Daniel suggests patience and perseverance in the journey towards one's personal Everest. Daniel's narrative reflects the journey of the Israelites when he says: "The journey to your 'personal Everest' is not going to be easy. It will be filled with obstacles and hardships. But the key is to persevere, to stay patient, and have faith in your abilities to overcome these challenges."*



Welcome to v3.04 where I delve into the idea of finding our purpose while escaping tyranny.

We don't always know where we're headed, but we must trust the process of maturing. You might be a little nervous about the unknown, but remember that wisdom and personal growth often come from confronting the unfamiliar. You'll note that I'm co-writing this print chapter with ChatGPT. I've finally acquired the tools to build a minyan that is available 24/7 to help me with communication challenges. I've prompted GPT to digest the transcript of this video and show me blind-spots, write summaries, thesis statement and character reviews. How cool this!

In this journey of life, it's crucial to not isolate yourself. You need to connect with others, to be 'roped up' with them, metaphorically speaking. The term "roped up" is borrowed from the practice of glacier crossing, where you connect with others to keep safe and prevent a fall into a crevasse. It's about staying interconnected and helping each other to avoid pitfalls.

This episode aims to foster a conversation about ***being roped up with others. It's about not going it alone, and not being manipulated or 'roped in' by external influences.*** *Our cognitive architecture allows us to simplify complex patterns and come to conclusions. But we need to put in the effort, use tools like triangulation to challenge our biases, or we might end up in a metaphorical crevasse, or at the end of our rope.*

In 2005, I embarked on a cross-country solo cycling expedition, the first of three. During these journeys, I developed a passion for exploration and understanding WIDWID (why I do what I do). Stuart Varney suggested that history is a great teacher if you are paying attention. Blaise Pascal advised that if you find someone who's walked the path you want to follow, learn from their initial steps.

I have chosen to follow the footsteps of Jordan Peterson, who recently conducted a series on the book of Exodus. It illuminated some key insights. The book of Exodus highlights how "durable a book can be, more durable than stone or empires. It underscores the importance of not bending reality or violating your conscience, as there is always a price to pay."

One of the central lessons of this episode is the importance of taking on personal responsibility for awareness. It's about recognizing when you're under the tyranny of another's decisions and mandates. Escaping this tyranny requires confrontation and stepping into situations that



might scare you. The journey towards self-actualization, as Maslow would put it, is filled with incremental changes.

As we progress, it's crucial to surround ourselves with positive influences rather than isolating ourselves. Four points stand out:

Being 'roped up' is about committing to your journey by following those who've been where you want to be and bringing along someone who's willing to commit to their journey.

The journey is incremental and unfolds over time. You will prepare for things without knowing their importance until much later.

Being roped up has tangible benefits. You learn from others' mistakes and successes, gaining wisdom that spans more than your time on Earth. That alone should beckon you.

"If you don't say what you think then you kill your unborn self."

— Jordan B. Peterson

Committing to your journey is crucial. The journey from tyranny, through the desert, and up your personal Everest requires awareness, understanding, and asking for help.

In conclusion, to get out of the rut of everyday life, you need to become aware of the things that bother you, face them, and ask for help. This way, you can make your way up your personal Everest. You can escape self-tyranny roped up with other explorers... even those that have taken their leave, having left a legacy of instructions to "follow in-the-way they began"

I hope this episode serves as a guide to lead you out of your own 'Scotomaville' and towards a life of purpose and fulfillment.

I'm looking forward to your feedback. I'll see you next episode.



"a line of five mature sages, seen from below, climbing **UP** a sand dune, roped inline like mountaineers, late in the afternoon, with long shadows"

https://youtu.be/LMt4CX37XJ8

personal everest

discipline



The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

Daniel Comp
@scotomaville
(210) 557-4779

crossing

underst

SCOTOMAVILLE



"Until one is committed, there is hesitancy, the chance to draw back, always ineffectiveness. Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation), there is one elementary truth, the ignorance of which kills countless ideas and splendid plans: **that the moment one definitely commits oneself, then Providence moves too.** All sorts of things occur to help one that would never otherwise have occurred. A whole stream of events issues from the decision, raising in one's favour all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way."

W. H. Murray
The Scottish Himalayan Expedition
(1951)

"Learn of those who have been bound like you, and who now stake all their possessions. These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. **Follow the way by which they began; by acting as if...**"

Blaise Pascal
Pascal's Wager
The Pensées (1670)

vernacular
syllabus

escaping tyranny
awareness

expedition
bricolage
charrette
awareness
abundant scarcity
scarce abundance
arrested development
amygdala hijacking
squalls & triggers
understanding tyrannny
pattern recognition
hieroglyphics
ai recommenders
precise vs accurate
popular vs true
onus probandi
lexicon corpus
avarice & hedonism
bread & circuses
offending strengths
cognitive bias
fixation
cynicism
machiavellian
onion peeling
error correction
triangulation
creating silence
persistence
emotional vocabulary
conversational implicature
imposter syndrome
toxic masculinity
cellular nutrition
gut wellness
incremental change
self-authoring
self-reflection
video modeling
mind mapping
diffuse time
imperative impediment
hopper pivoting
discipline
story telling
actualization
personal everest

tanding
a desert



WATCH

https://youtu.be/LMt4CX37XJ8

Escaping tyranny takes more than luck. You must rope-up with others - especially to develop critical thinking skills while crossing your desert. You can mature much quicker, and immensely safer by having someone to follow, and someone to lead. You can then arrest your falls into crevasses, with a much shorter rope! ChatGPT, what do you think?

In the journey of life, it's crucial to consciously move away from dependence and tyranny by embracing personal responsibility, gaining self-awareness, seeking wisdom from mentors, and harnessing the power of community. These elements collectively facilitate a process of transformation, personal growth, and finding one's purpose, similar to navigating through the desert to reach one's personal Everest

How does the metaphor of climbing Mount Everest in Daniel's episode intersect with your personal journey of acquiring emotional and digital 'literacy' in order to escape tyranny?

DISCUSS



You know the gig. Share a jewel.

UNITED AIRLINES
HEMISPHERES

Entrepreneur MAGAZINE

Nationally Syndicated
W
Wellness by Choice

@scotomaville
Authors as seen in/on...

D SCOTTSDALE PHOENIX MAGAZINE

SUCCESS

KARE 11

ISBN 978-0-1234-6578-8

SCO OMA



v1
Awareness

Tools to Discover WYDWYD

v2
Understanding

Insights to Master the Discovery Tools

v3
Discipline

Literacy to Gain Self-Mastery